This is an unexpectedly good soup, with all the fresh, nutty flavor of Brussels sprouts tempered by the natural sweetness of the onion.

brussels sprout soup

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 10 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
WITHOUT THE SOUR CREAM

1lb (450g) onions, sliced
2 tbsp butter
1 tbsp sugar
1lb (450g) Brussels sprouts, trimmed and halved
1 generous sprig thyme
1¼ quarts (1¼ liters) chicken or vegetable stock
salt and freshly ground black pepper
sour cream, crème fraîche, or Greek-style yogurt, to serve
paprika or cayenne pepper, to serve

1 Place the onions in a pan with the butter. Cover and cook over low heat for about 30–40 minutes until the onions are incredibly tender and soft. Sprinkle in the sugar and cook, uncovered, for another 10–15 minutes or so until the onions are lightly colored and concentrated, stirring occasionally.

2 Add the sprouts and the thyme and stir. Pour in the stock and season with salt and pepper. Bring to a boil and simmer for 10–15 minutes until the sprouts are just tender. Cool slightly, remove the thyme, and process in two batches. Reheat gently if needed, then taste and adjust the seasoning. Serve piping hot, with a spoonful of sour cream, crème fraîche, or yogurt in each bowlful, and a light dusting of paprika or cayenne.



BRUSSELS SPROUTS
Look for locally grown sprouts. They can range from the size of a thumbnail to a golf ball, but smaller equals sweeter. Before using home-grown sprouts, soak them in cold water, as they may contain a few worms.